



Chalmers Challenge

2025

A - Cups and Balls

- Problem
 - Cups and balls
 - Keep track of which cup the ball is underneath to help figure out what cups to swap to make Hugo guess correctly
- Solution
 - Keep track of which cup the ball resides under using an integer between 1 and 3, re-assigning it when one of the cups is equal to it
 - Handle the case when the ball is under Hugo's guessed cup separately, and select the other cups
 - Else switch Hugo's cup with the cup that the ball is under

A - Cups and Balls

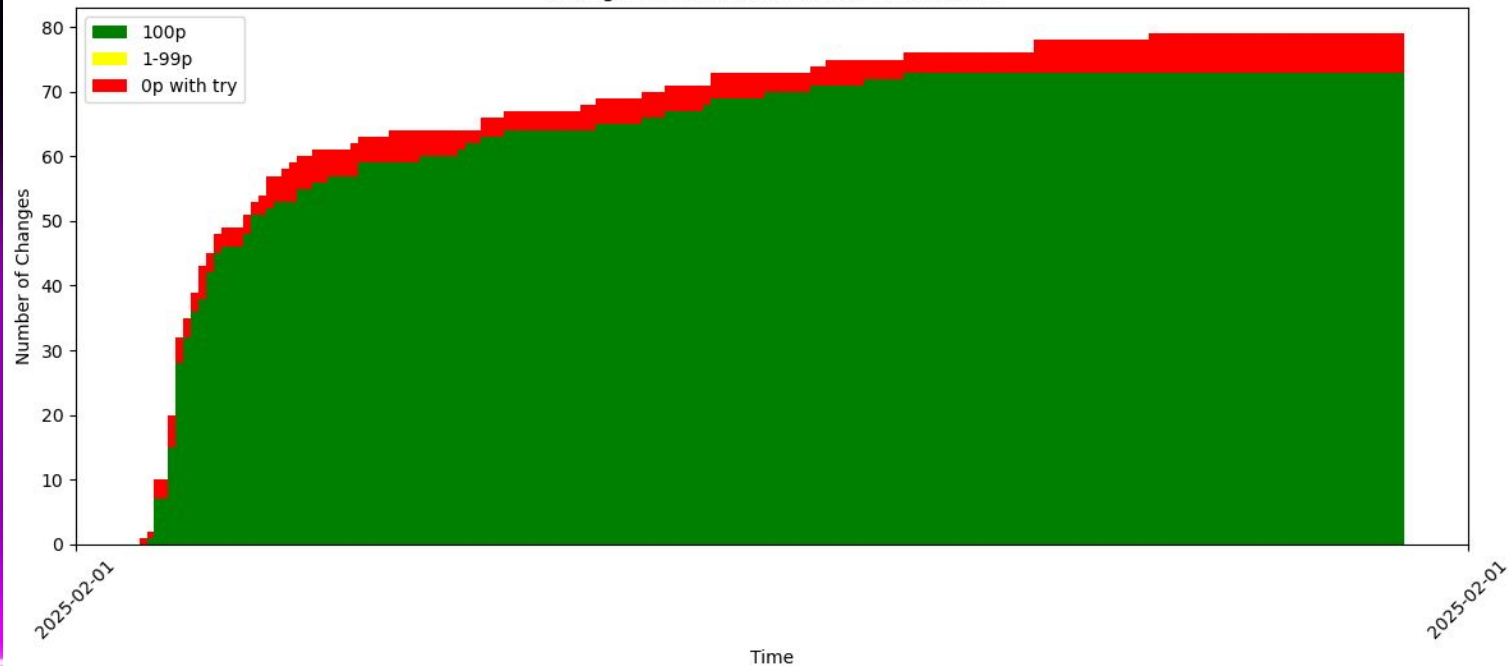
```
ball = 2
hugo_guess = int(input())
for i in range(int(input())):
    swap1, swap2 = map(int, input().split())
    if ball == swap1:
        ball = swap2
    elif ball == swap2:
        ball = swap1

if ball == hugo_guess:
    other_cups = "123".replace(str(ball), _new: "")
    print(other_cups[0], other_cups[1])
else:
    print(hugo_guess, ball)
```

A - Cups and Balls

Problem: Problem A

Changes in Scores for Problem: Problem A



B - Overnight Oats

- Problem
 - N -day period, X -day shelf life
 - Each evening, Julia can either do nothing (PASS), EAT or ADD overnights oats
 - In the end there will be no overnight oats left
 - Will Julia ever eat expired overnight oats?
- Solution
 - Simulate the events, add overnight oats when needed, remove overnight oats when needed

B - Overnight Oats

- Pseudo code:
 - For every day:
 - If PASS:
 - continue
 - Else if ADD:
 - Add to refrigerator
 - Else if EAT:
 - Remove *oldest* overnight oats
 - If expired, exit with “ono..”
 - print “yay!”

B - Overnight Oats

- Pseudo code:

- For every day:

- If PASS:

- continue

- Else if ADD:

- Add to refrigerator

- Else if EAT:

- Remove *oldest* overnight oats

- If expired, exit with "ono.."

- print "yay!"

Quadratic solution if this step is linear (e.g. popping first element of a list/looping to find oldest)

Linear solution if this is constant time (queue)

B - Overnight Oats

```
1 import heapq
2
3
4 days = int(input())
5 shelf = int(input())
6
7
8 oatlist = []
9
10
11 for i in range(days):
12     action = input()
13     if action == "ADD":
14         heapq.heappush(oatlist, i)
15     if action == "PASS":
16         continue
17     if action == "EAT":
18         cur_oat_birthday = heapq.heappop(oatlist)
19         if i - cur_oat_birthday > shelf:
20             print("ono..")
21             exit()
22
23 print("yay!")
```

_BuyHighSellLow (Rickard)

B - Overnight Oats

Problem: Problem B

Changes in Scores for Problem: Problem B

Number of Changes

Time

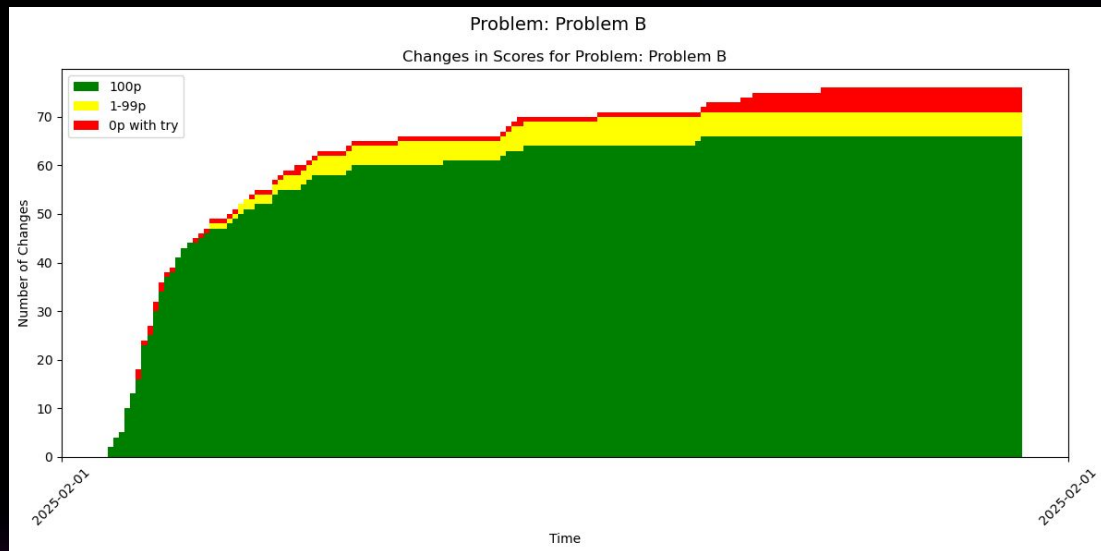
2025-02-01

2025-02-01

Legend:

- 100p
- 1-99p
- 0p with try

Time	100p	1-99p	0p with try	Total
2025-02-01 00:00	0	0	0	0
2025-02-01 01:00	10	0	0	10
2025-02-01 02:00	25	0	0	25
2025-02-01 03:00	40	0	0	40
2025-02-01 04:00	45	0	0	45
2025-02-01 05:00	48	0	0	48
2025-02-01 06:00	50	0	0	50
2025-02-01 07:00	52	0	0	52
2025-02-01 08:00	55	0	0	55
2025-02-01 09:00	58	0	0	58
2025-02-01 10:00	60	0	0	60
2025-02-01 11:00	62	0	0	62
2025-02-01 12:00	63	0	0	63
2025-02-01 13:00	64	0	0	64
2025-02-01 14:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 15:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 16:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 17:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 18:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 19:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 20:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 21:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 22:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 23:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 00:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 01:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 02:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 03:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 04:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 05:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 06:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 07:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 08:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 09:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 10:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 11:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 12:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 13:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 14:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 15:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 16:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 17:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 18:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 19:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 20:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 21:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 22:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 23:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 00:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 01:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 02:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 03:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 04:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 05:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 06:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 07:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 08:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 09:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 10:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 11:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 12:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 13:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 14:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 15:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 16:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 17:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 18:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 19:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 20:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 21:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 22:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 23:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 00:00	65	0	0	65
2025-02-01 01:00	65	0	0	65
2				



C - Passing Time

- Problem:
 - Some cards have been drawn from a shuffled deck of cards
 - You are tasked with finding the probability that you can correctly guess the top card's rank, using the most optimal strategy
- Solution:
 - The most optimal strategy will be to pick the rank that there are most cards of.
 - This means we can keep track of the counts of the different ranks using a dictionary
 - Then we can divide the maximum number of one of the ranks with the amount of cards remaining in the deck

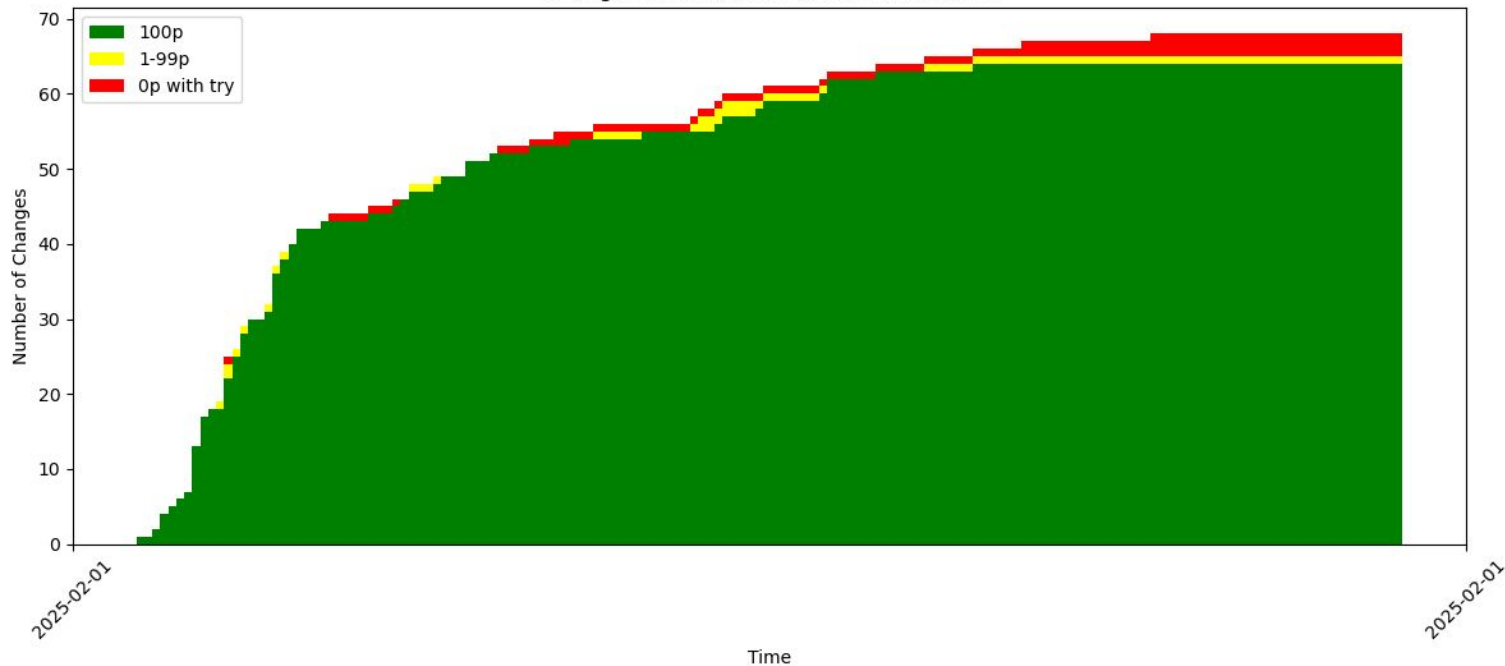
C - Passing Time

```
ranks = ["A", "2", "3", "4", "5", "6", "7",  
         "8", "9", "10", "J", "Q", "K"]  
counts = {r:4 for r in ranks}  
  
n = int(input())  
for _ in range(n):  
    card = input()  
    rank = card[:-1]  
    counts[rank] -= 1  
  
most = max(counts.values())  
remaining_cards = 52 - n  
print(most / remaining_cards)
```

C - Passing Time

Problem: Problem C

Changes in Scores for Problem: Problem C



D - Bouquet

Sample Input 2

```
5
-1 0 B
-3 0 R
2 3 R
1 1 G
-3 3 G
```

Sample Output 2

```
8.537319187990756
```

D - Bouquet

```
n = int(input())
pos = []
colors = []
for i in range(n):
    x, y, color = input().split()
    pos.append((int(x), int(y)))
    colors.append(color)

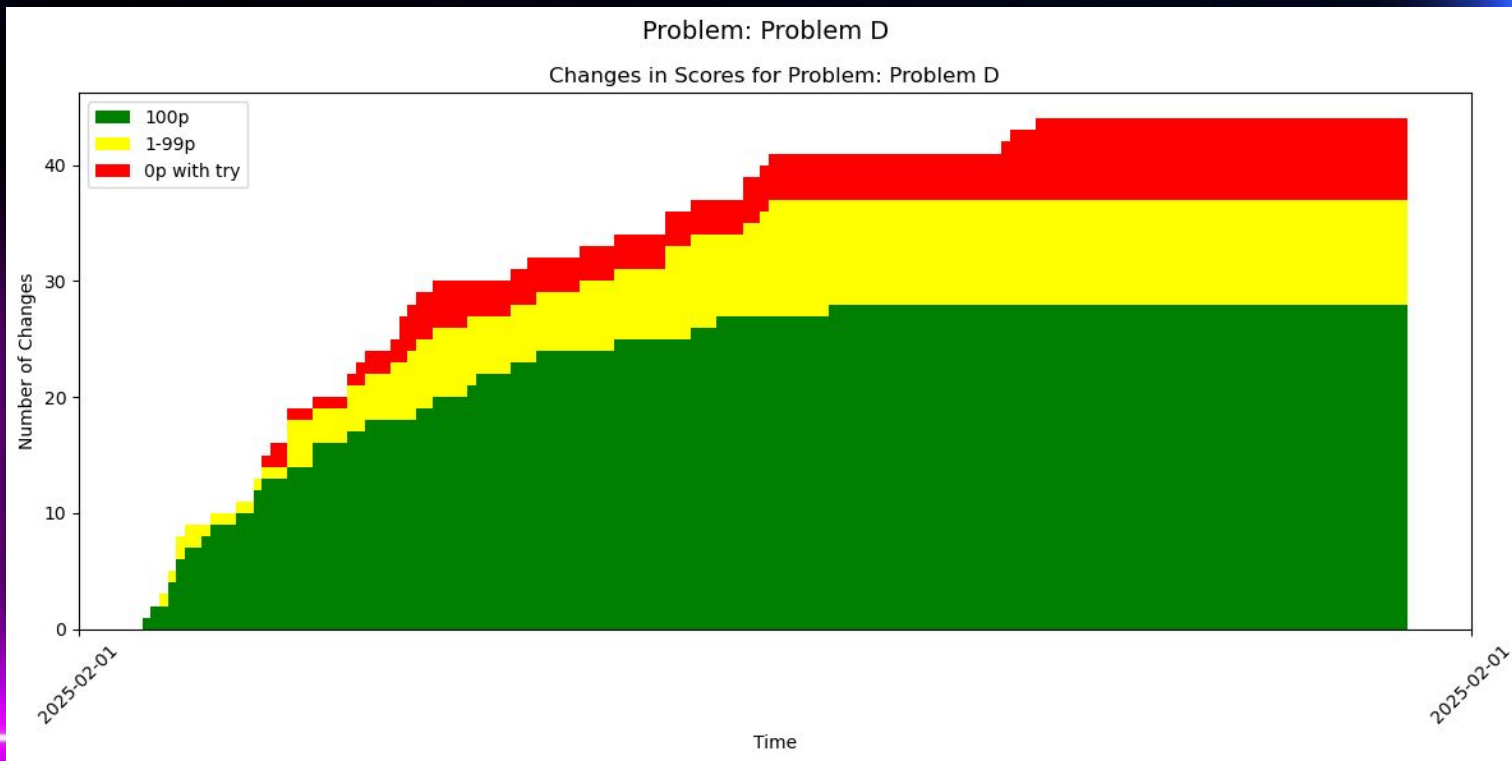
ans = 1e10
for f1 in range(n):
    for f2 in range(n):
        for f3 in range(n):
            if len({colors[f1], colors[f2], colors[f3]}) == 3:
                ans = min(
                    ans,
                    dist((0,0), pos[f1]) + dist(pos[f1], pos[f2])
                    + dist(pos[f2], pos[f3]) + dist(pos[f3], (0, 0))
                )
print(ans)
```


D - Bouquet

```
double ans = 1e30;
for(i(n) {
    for(j(3) best[j] = 1e30;
    for(j(n) if (c[j] != c[i]) {
        double d = sqrt(x[j] * x[j] + y[j] * y[j]) + sqrt((x[j] - x[i]) * (x[j] - x[i]) + (y[j] - y[i]) * (y[j] - y[i]));
        best[c[j]] = min(best[c[j]], d);
    }
    double cur = 0;
    for(j(3) if (j != c[i]) cur += best[j];
    ans = min(ans, cur);
}
writeln(ans);
```

Alexander Kravberg

D - Bouquet



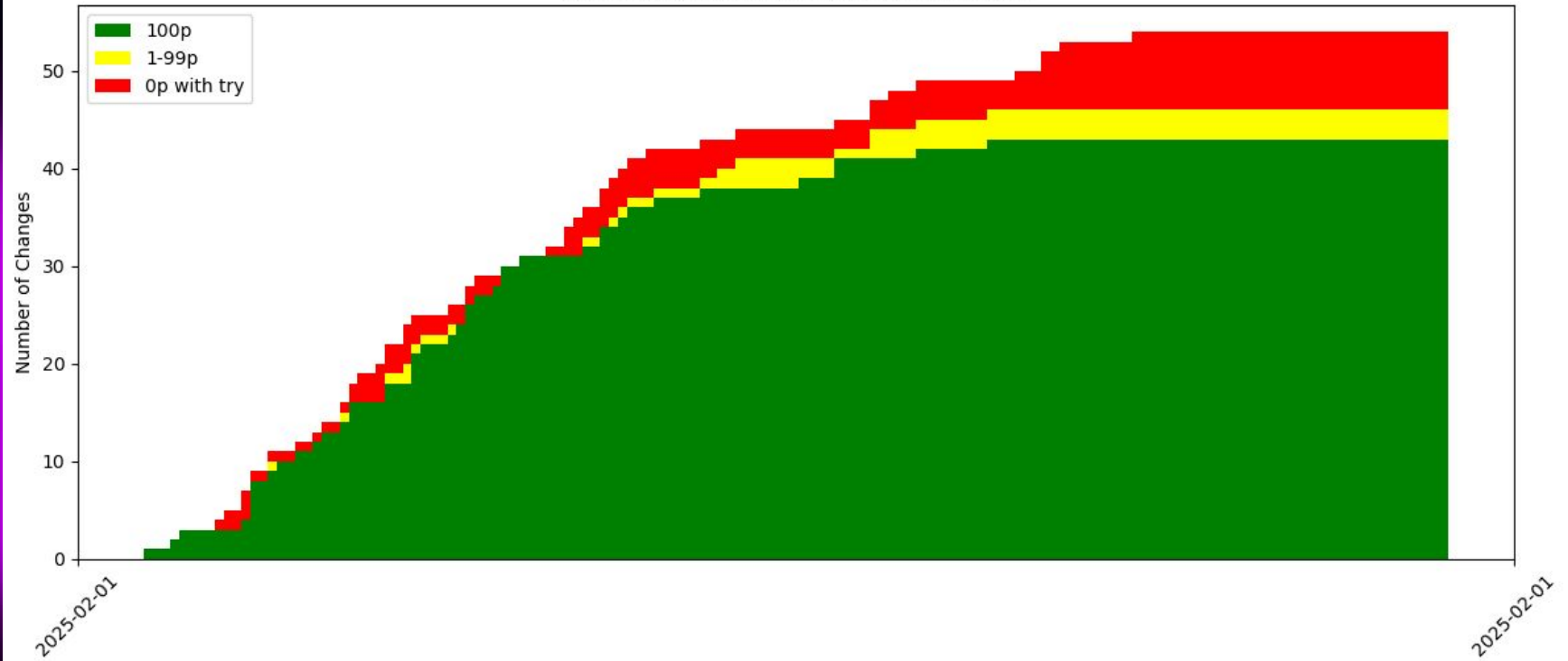
E - Mountainpeeker

- Problem
 - How many mountain peaks can Joel see?
- Solution
 - 40 points: For each mountain peak, check if any other mountain peak is blocking the view, for example by comparing angles (or simply ratio $(y-h) / x$). $O(n^2)$
 - 50 points: Split mountains into left and right, they solve equivalently for both sides, setting $x = -x$ for left side.
 - 100 points: Sort both sides in increasing x -distance, then go through the list and keep track of largest seen angle, every increase corresponds to a mountain peak in view. $O(n \log n)$

E - Mountainpeeker

Problem: Problem E

Changes in Scores for Problem: Problem E



F - CCC Camp

- Problem
 - N points contributing 1 or 2 cups of coffee
 - M intervals
 - We want to count how many cups of coffee belonging to points that are not inside any interval
- Solution
 - Order points by their position
 - Order all intervals based on start position
 - Go through all the people one by one and keep a pointer for the current interval (starting at the first interval). If the current person is to the left of the current interval, we can mark it as not belonging to any interval, thus summing its cups of coffee, and if it is to the right we increase the interval pointer.

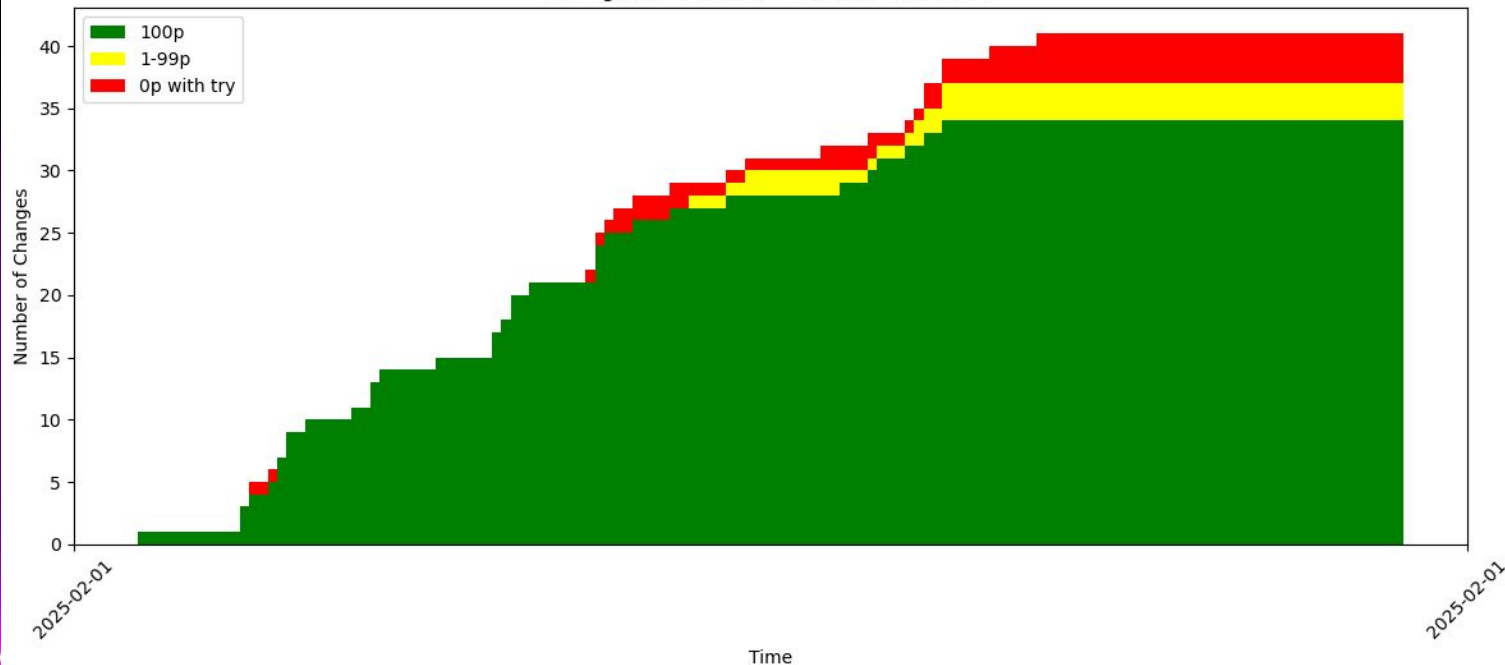
F - CCC Camp

```
n,m = map(int,input().split())
a = []
for _ in range(n):
    name, pos = input().split()
    a.append((int(pos), 1 + (name in ("Joshua", "Gustav"))))
b = [tuple(map(int, input().split())) for _ in range(m)]
a.sort()
b.sort()
i = 0
cnt = 0
for p, c in a:
    while i < m and p > b[i][1]:
        i += 1
    if i >= m or b[i][0] > p:
        cnt += c
print(cnt)
```


F - CCC Camp

Problem: Problem F

Changes in Scores for Problem: Problem F



G - Memento

There are multiple possible solutions.

Classic unlabeled graph isomorphism algorithms are exponential.

We basically need a property of graphs that is invariant (unchanging) to relabeling vertices. Perhaps there is a way to add the edges to achieve this.

Consider adding the 30 edges to some arbitrary node. What is the probability that there will be another node with degree ≥ 30 ?

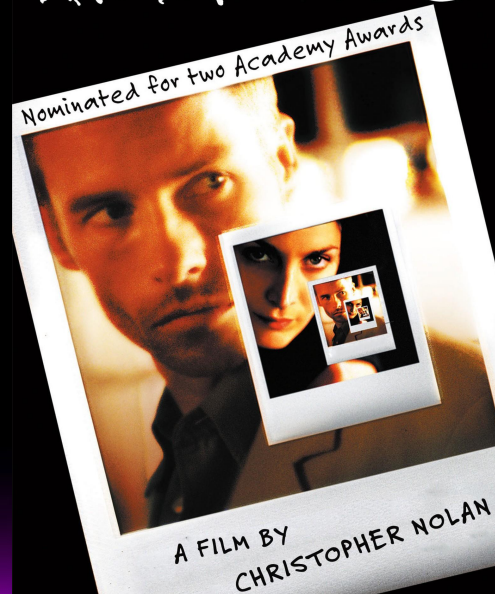
G - Memento

Remember that the graph is generated with maximum 4500 edges distributed uniformly to the 1000 vertices. The expected degree of a vertex is $4500 \cdot 2 / 1000 = 9$. You could calculate the variance here or probability of a vertex having a degree ≥ 30 . Intuitively, the probability is very small. It turns out that it is negligible and the solution works.

You could be extra safe and instead of choosing an arbitrary node to add the 30 edges to, pick the node of highest degree to add the edges too and connect the edges to the vertices of lowest degrees.

G - Memento

MEMENTO



G - Memento

MEMENTO

```
1  def run(edges):
2      degree = [0] * 1000
3      for a, b in edges:
4          degree[a] += 1
5          degree[b] += 1
6      if max(degree) >= 30:
7          return []
8      hasEdgeTo0 = [False] * 1000
9      for a, b in edges:
10         if a == 0:
11             hasEdgeTo0[b] = True
12         elif b == 0:
13             hasEdgeTo0[a] = True
14     ret = []
15     for i in range(1, 1000):
16         if not hasEdgeTo0[i]:
17             ret.append([0, i])
18         if len(ret) >= 30:
19             break
20     return ret
21
```



G - Memento

Problem: Problem G

Changes in Scores for Problem: Problem G

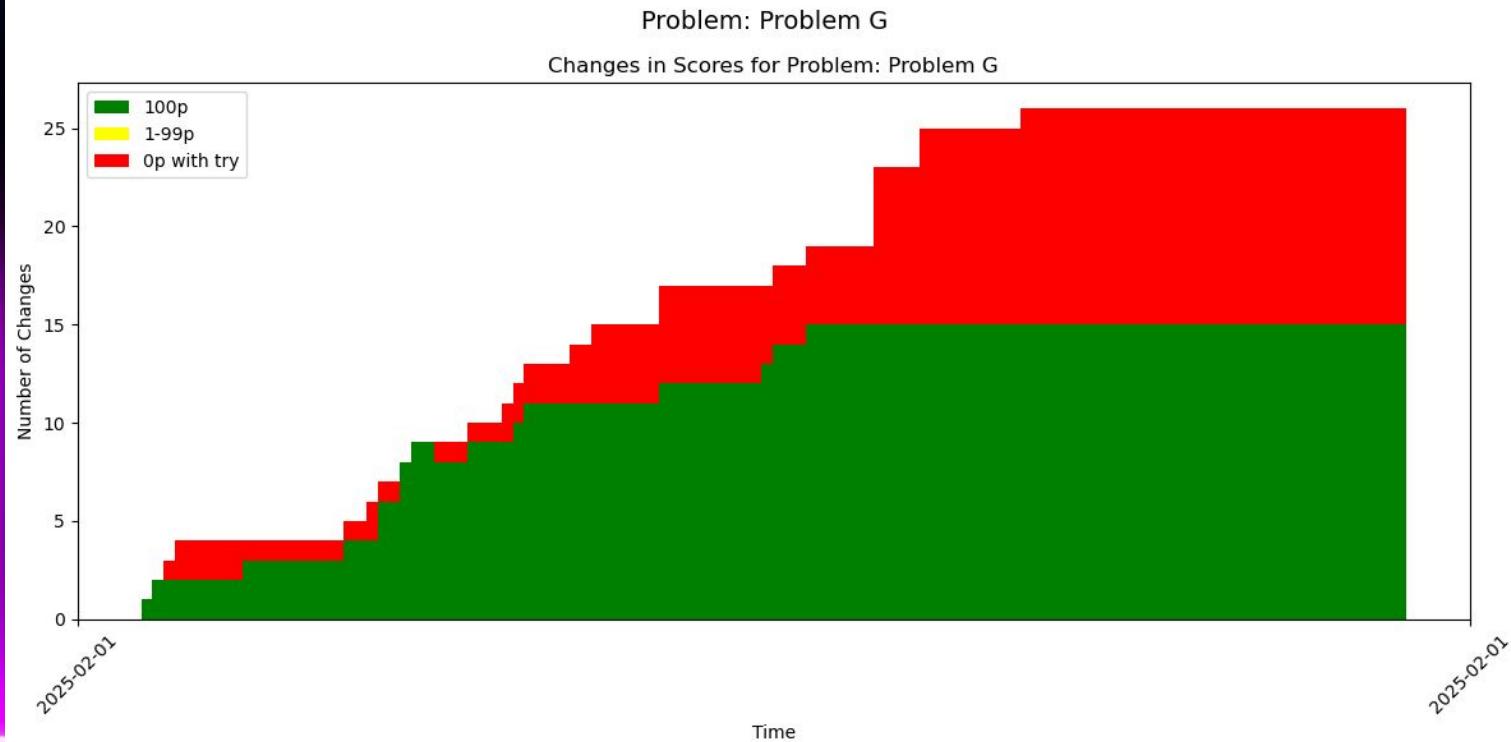
Number of Changes

Time

2025-02-01

2025-02-01

Time	100p	0p with try	Total Score
2025-02-01 00:00:00	0	0	0
2025-02-01 00:01:00	1	0	1
2025-02-01 00:02:00	2	0	2
2025-02-01 00:03:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:04:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:05:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:06:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:07:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:08:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:09:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:10:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:11:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:12:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:13:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:14:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:15:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:16:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:17:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:18:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:19:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:20:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:21:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:22:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:23:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:24:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:25:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:26:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:27:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:28:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:29:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:30:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:31:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:32:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:33:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:34:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:35:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:36:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:37:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:38:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:39:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:40:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:41:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:42:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:43:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:44:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:45:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:46:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:47:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:48:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:49:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:50:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:51:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:52:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:53:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:54:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:55:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:56:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:57:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:58:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 00:59:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 01:00:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 01:01:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 01:02:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 01:03:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 01:04:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 01:05:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 01:06:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 01:07:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 01:08:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 01:09:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 01:10:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 01:11:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 01:12:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 01:13:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 01:14:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 01:15:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 01:16:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 01:17:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 01:18:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 01:19:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 01:20:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 01:21:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 01:22:00	2	1	3
2025-02-01 01:23:00	2	1	3
20			



H - Exploring Delsjön

There is a tree. We are given the distance between every pair of leaf nodes (nodes with degree 1) in it. Given this, find any tree which has the same distances between its leaves.

H - Exploring Delsjön

“Interior nodes” are non-leaf nodes. Add interior nodes to connect leaf 0 and 1. Then, add interior nodes to connect leaf 0,1,2. Etc.

Well-known fact: the distance between two nodes (a,b) in a tree is $\text{depth}[a] + \text{depth}[b] - 2 * \text{depth}[\text{lca}(a,b)]$

Let's root the tree at leaf 0.

Now, we know the depth of all other leaves.

H - Exploring Delsjön

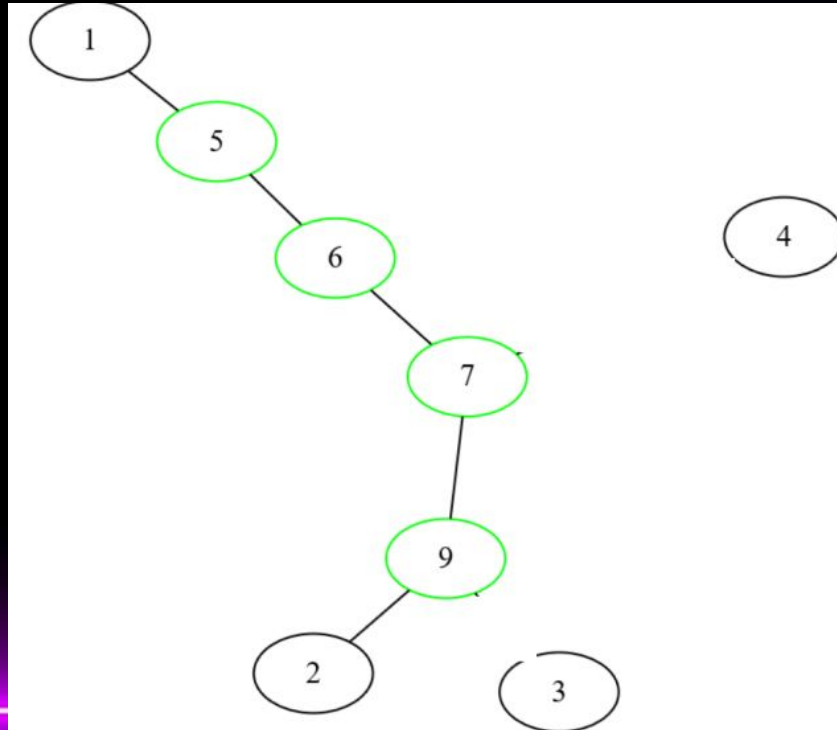
Since we know the depth of all leaves (0 is 0, rest is $\text{dist}(0,a)$), we can solve for the depth of the lca using

$$\text{depth}[a] + \text{depth}[b] - 2 * \text{depth}[\text{lca}(a,b)]$$

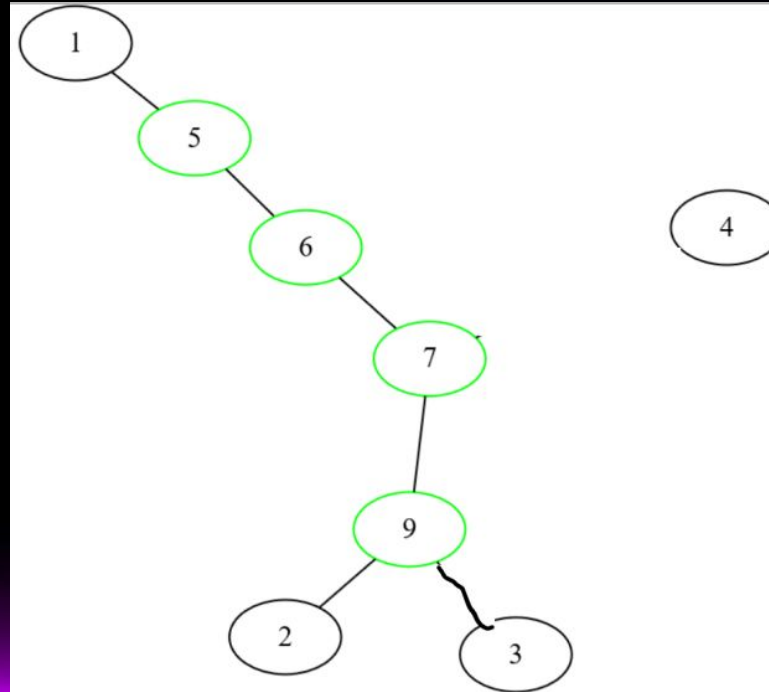
Let us try to insert leaf L. Compute the depth of $\text{lca}(i,L)$ for each $i < L$. We will insert a path from L $\rightarrow$ the deepest lca. Use difference in depth between L and the lca to find number of nodes

Implementation detail: add a path from leaf 0 to 1 instantly

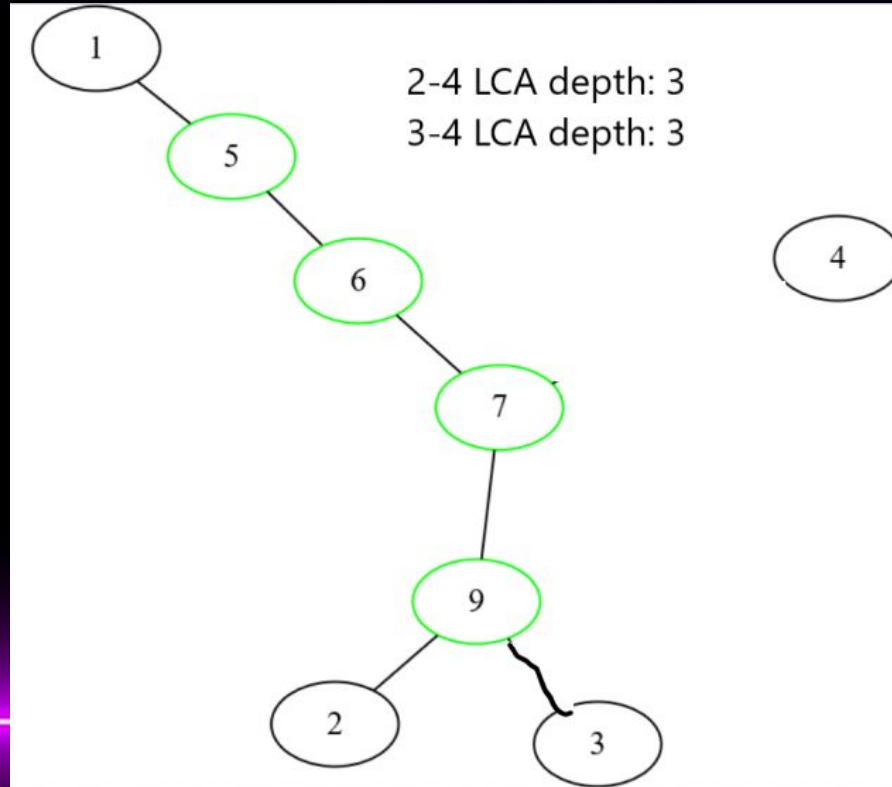
H - Exploring Delsjön



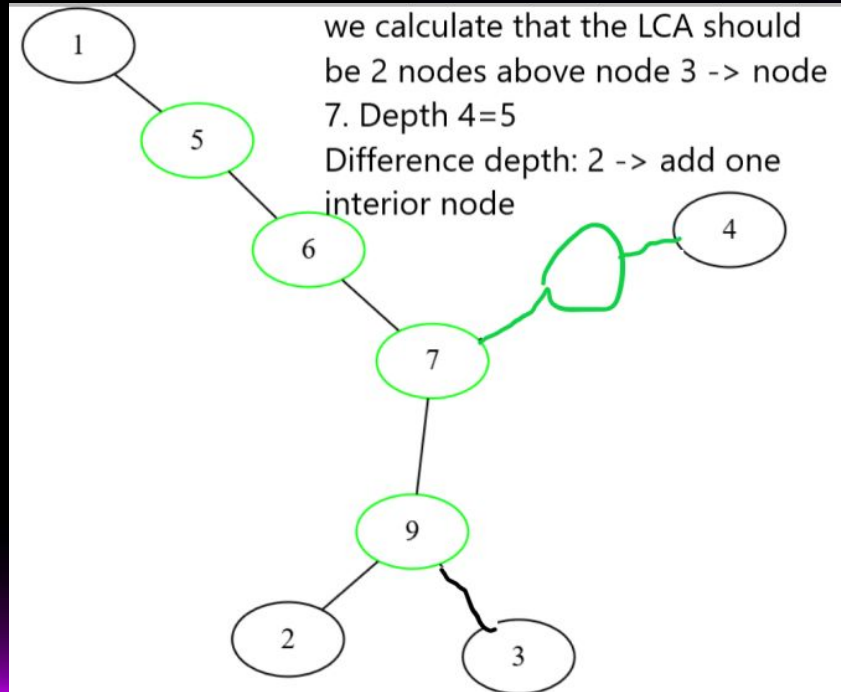
H - Exploring Delsjön



H - Exploring Delsjön



H - Exploring Delsjön



H - Exploring Delsjön



I - Polkagris

Problem: Can a given $1e7$ long string be converted into another given string, using “folds”?

A fold is equivalent to removing the K first(last) characters of a $2K+1$ long palindrome prefix(suffix)

ABABABCA

--ABABCA

---BABCA

----ABCA

I - Polkagris

Observation: We will only ever have substrings of the initial string.

Consider a graph with nodes corresponding to substring slices $[L,R]$. If $s[L-1] = s[L+1]$ we have an edge from $[L-1,R]$ to $[L,R]$, etc.

$O(N^3)$: DP on this graph, then check all end states corresponding to substrings equal to the target.

I - Polkagris

```
N, T = [int(x) for x in input().split()]
initial = input()
target = input()

# whether initial can be folded into initial[l:r+1]
memo = {}
def dp(l,r):
    if l == 0 and r == len(initial)-1: return True
    if (l,r) in memo: return memo[l,r]
    k = r-l+1
    for i in range(1,k):
        assert l+i <= r
        if (l-i < 0) or initial[l+i] != initial[l-i]: break
        if dp(l-i,r):
            memo[l,r] = True
            return True
    for i in range(1,k):
        assert r-i >= l
        if (r+i >= len(initial)) or initial[r-i] != initial[r+i]: break
        if dp(l,r+i):
            memo[l,r] = True
            return True
    memo[l,r] = False
    return False

def possible(target):
    for l in range(len(initial)-len(target)+1):
        r = l+len(target)-1
        if initial[l:r+1] == target and dp(l,l+len(target)-1):
            return True
    return False

if possible(target) or possible(target[::-1]):
    print("possible")
else:
    print("impossible")
```

DP[L,R]

Recurse into DP[L-i,R] for $2i+1$ long palindromes centered at L

Finally, at every offset into the string

1. Check if matches target
2. Check if DP is true

(Also check for target[::-1]!)

I - Polkagris

1st way of
optimizing to
quadratic:

Recurse into $DP[L-i, R]$ for $2i+1$
long palindromes centered at L
^^

Can precompute length of
palindrome centered at L in
 $O(N^2)$.

Can use prefix sum to check if
any $DP[L-i, R]$ for i in $1..(\text{length}$
of palindrome)

2nd way of
optimizing to
quadratic:

I - Polkagris

Folding one side is almost
independent from the other side.
Could we do 2 linear-state DPs
instead of a single quadratic one?

Yes! Any folds large enough to affect
the other side could WLOG be
shortened by applying any of the
other sides recent folds.

I - Polkagris

Applying both (prefix sum + two linear-state DPs) gives a linear solution, if

1. We compute palindrome widths in linear time (Manacher)
2. We find all substrings in the input equal to the target (KMP)

Both in KACTL

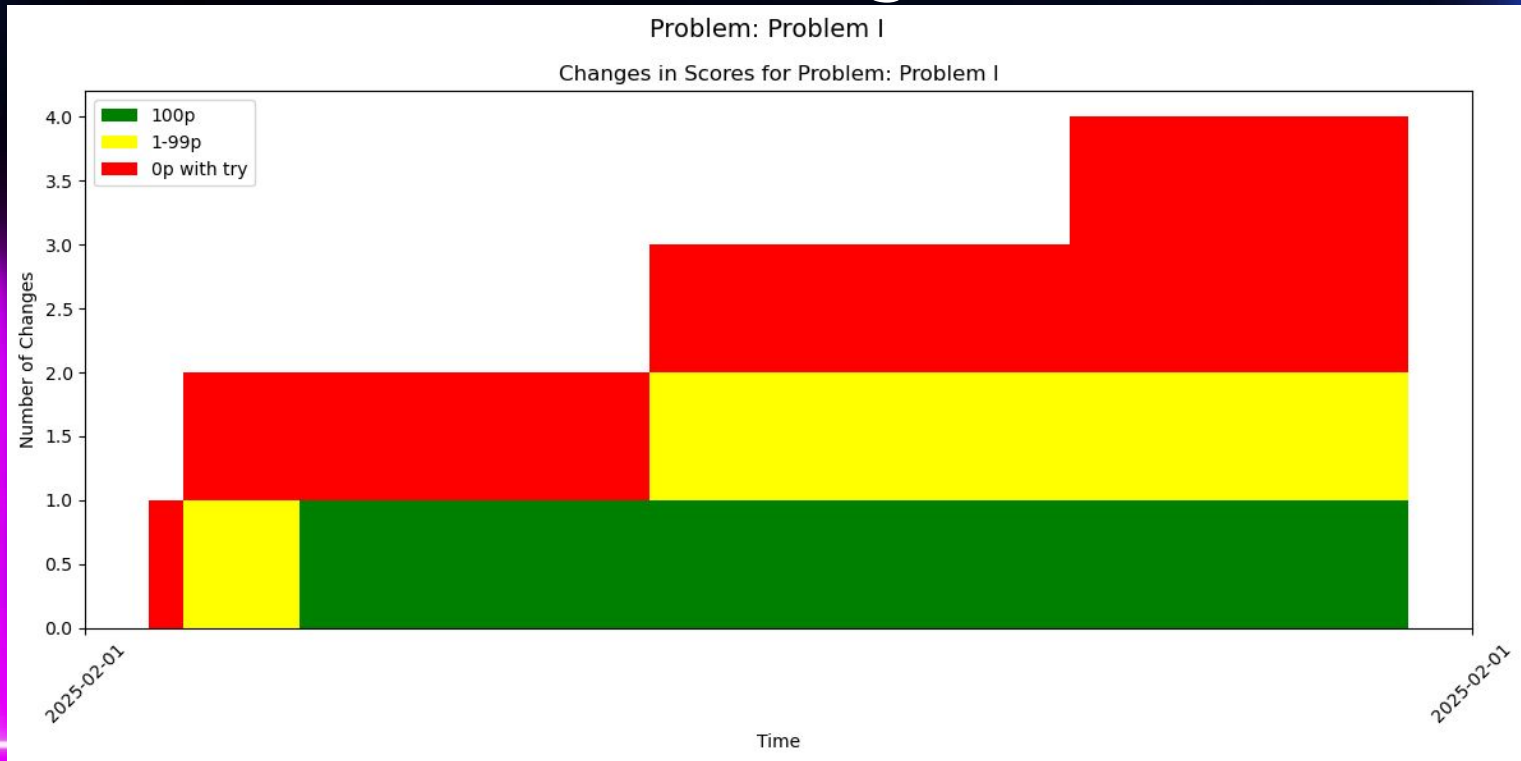
I - Polkagris

```
62 int main(){
63     cin.tie(0);
64     ios::sync_with_stdio(false);
65
66     ll n,m; cin>>n>>m;
67
68     ll mxsz = n+3;
69     pw.resize(mxsz);
70     invpw.resize(mxsz);
71     pw[0] = 1;
72     invpw[0] = 1;
73     rep(i,1,mxsz){
74         pw[i] = pw[i-1]*base;
75         invpw[i] = modInverse(pw[i]);
76         // cout<<invpw[i]*pw[i]<<endl;
77     }
78
79     // cout<<modInverse(base)*base<<endl;
80
81
82     string a; cin>>a;
83     string b; cin>>b;
84
85     IntervalHash ha(a);
86     RevIntervalHash rha(a);
87
88     // rep(i,0,9) cout<<ha.get(i,i+3)<<" ";
89     // cout<<endl;
90     // rep(i,0,9) cout<<rha.get(i,i+3)<<" ";
91     // cout<<endl;
92
93     IntervalHash hb(b);
94     RevIntervalHash rhb(b);
95     uint32_t bhs = hb.get(0,m);
96
97     vector<bool> canCutPref(n);
98     canCutPref[0] = true;
99     ll closestCut = 0;
100     rep(i,1,n){
101         ll ln = (i+1-closestCut);
102         if(ln+i > n) break;
103         if(ha.get(i-ln+1,i+1) == rha.get(i,ln+i)){
104             canCutPref[i] = true;
105             closestCut = i;
106         }
107     }
108
109     vector<bool> canCutSuf(n);
110     canCutSuf[n-1] = true;
111     closestCut = n-1;
112     for(int i=n-2;i>=0;i--){
113         ll ln = (closestCut-i+1);
114         if(i+1-ln < 0) break;
115         if(rha.get(i,ln+i) == ha.get(i+1-ln,i+1)){
116             canCutSuf[i] = true;
117             closestCut = i;
118         }
119     }
120 }
121
```

```
130
131     rep(i,0,n-m+1){
132         // cout<<i<<endl;
133         // cout<< canCutPref[i] <<" " << canCutSuf[i+m-1] <<" " << (ha.get(i,i+m) == bhs) <<" " <<
134         if(canCutPref[i] && canCutSuf[i+m-1] && (ha.get(i,i+m) == bhs || rha.get(i,i+m) == bhs)){
135             cout<<"possible"<<endl;
136             _Exit(0);
137         }
138     }
139
140     // reverse(all(b1));
141     // if(solve(b1)){
142     //     cout<<"possible"<<endl;
143     //     return 0;
144     // };
145     cout<<"impossible"<<endl;
146
147     _Exit(0);
148 }
149
150 // BABACABACABA
151 // 111010101000
```

Fredrik Ekholm
(Other solutions include top-down DP, and
some optimized quadratic)

I - Polkagris



J - Building a Castle

First, realize that this is basically “find 4 non-intersecting increasing subsequences of maximum length”. The K constraint doesn't really change the solution.

Or does it?

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Longest subsequence which is a union of K increasing subsequences

By [Halzion](#), [history](#), 3 years ago, 

I was reading [mango_jassi](#)'s [blog](#) and in one of the [paper](#) referred in his blog, I found a $O(N^2)$ algorithm for constructing a longest k-increasing subsequence (a subsequence of maximum length which is a union of k increasing subsequences). While implementing it, [ko_osaga](#) told me about the problem E in "AMPPZ-2015 MIPT-2015 ACM-ICPC Workshop Round 1" (id #6275 in opentrain) where the problem asks to construct such subsequence with constraint $N \leq 2 \cdot 10^5$ and $K \leq 20$.

The official solution runs in $O(N \cdot K \cdot (K + \log(N)))$. The first half seems to be doing the RSK mapping, but I couldn't figure out why the second half works. It seems to be unrolling the mapping from the back, and maintaining K intervals for each row in the tableau. And the editorial only explains the first half. Can someone please explain why it works?

[▶ Official Solution](#)



Well-known in china
(RSK)

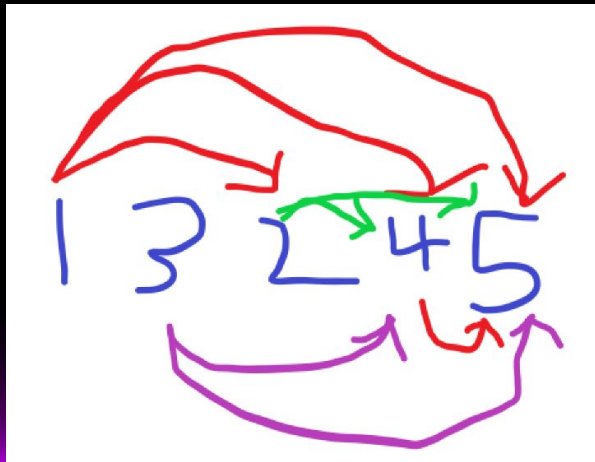
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N^5 : do a DP, keep track of the heights of each tower.

$N^4 \log(N)$: optimize previous DP. Use the same ideas to take normal longest increasing subsequence (LIS) from $O(N^2)$ to $O(N \log(N))$. Alternatively, writing a tight bottom-up is approximately as fast..

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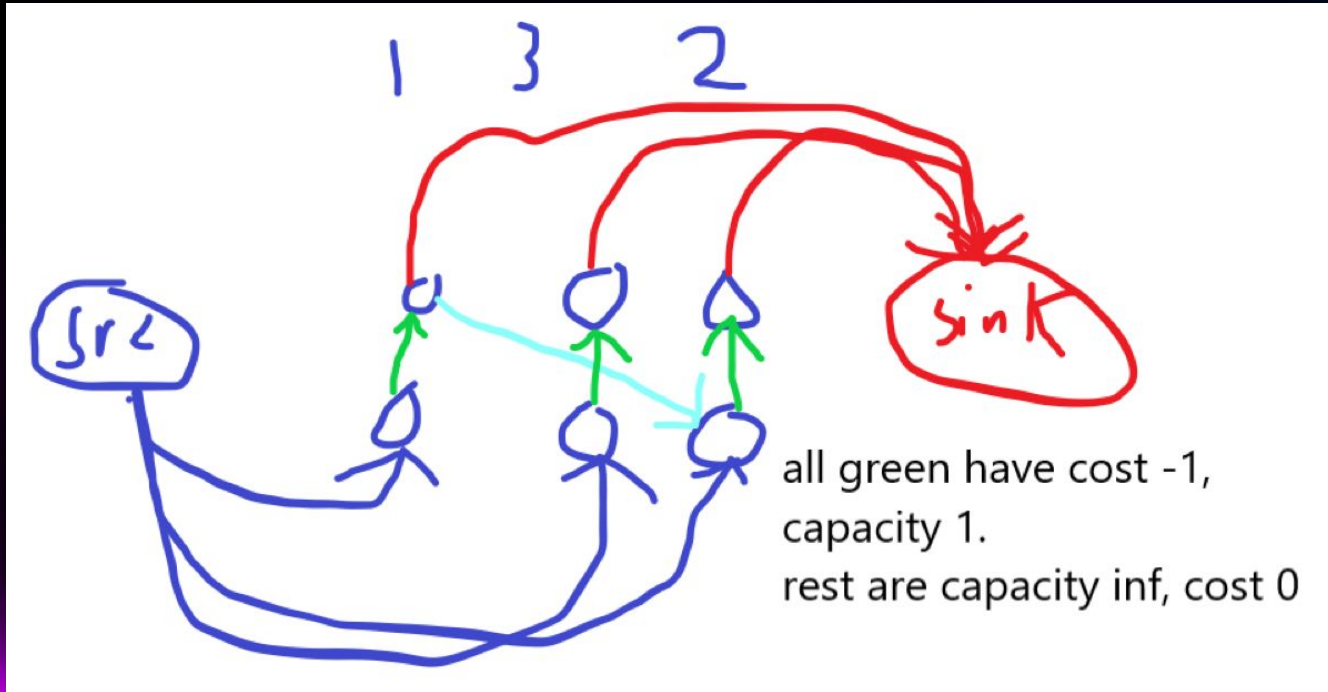
Fundamentally, DP is difficult to optimize further. Let's switch perspective. Normal LIS can be thought of as longest path, where we have a directed edge from i to j if $j > i$ and $h[j] > h[i]$.



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We will generalize this idea. Let's use flow. If we think a little, we can realize that letting each K -increasing subsequence be one flow, by finding min-cost max flow, we get our answer.

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There are $O(N^2)$ edges. We only need to find 4 flow, so let's use an augmenting path-based algorithm. Two main ways:

Find each augmenting path using shortest path with negative weights

SPFA: $O(N^3)$, may perform like $O(N^2)$ in practice

Bellman-ford: $O(N^2)$

Precompute potentials, then find each augmenting path in $O(E \log(E))$:

Bellman ford: $O(N^3)$, $O(N^2)$ if you introduce early breaks

SPFA: probably fast enough for $O(N^2)$

Shortest path DP: definitely $O(N^2)$

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How do we optimize further? Our graph may have $O(N^2)$ edges, so we can't consider them explicitly. What do we need to perform min cost max flow? Repeatedly find shortest path, where some edges are flipped.

If no edges are flipped, they have a simple form, so we can use a segment tree as in normal LIS.

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From here, we could probably solve the problem by carefully implementing our own min cost max flow with segment tree+potentials. The judge(s) have not bothered with this.

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Well-known fact: in a random permutation, expected length of LIS is $O(\sqrt{N})$. We assume worst-case of $K=1$. We can guess that 4 LIS length is $\sim 4\sqrt{N}$. Thus, we can infer that there will be at most that many flipped edges.

If we only go left-to right in the DAG, we can do this using segment tree in $O(N\log(N))$. We can also go right-to-left using flipped edges in $O(\sqrt{N})$ (remember, not many flipped edges).

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Find the shortest path in each direction alternatingly until no more distances are updated. If the order of edge relaxations right-to-left are wrong, it will run in

$\sim O(4 \cdot 4 \sqrt{N} N \log(N))$

If the order of edge relaxations is proper, it will take about 9 back-and-forths. $\sim O(4 \cdot 9 \cdot N \log(N))$. Works because random permutation

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